THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why is the Shaka Samvat valuable to astronomers and historians? 1

(a) it provides a fixed starting point for dating
(b) it is a city
(c) it is a script
(d) it is a coin

2. Which of these is a historical evidence for science in the Gupta age? 1

(a) Silappadikaram **(b)** Aryabhatiya **(c)** Indica **(d)** Arthashastra

3. An inscription lists guilds donating to a monastery. This shows 1

(a) foreign rule
(b) economic strength of guilds and patronage
(c) decline of trade
(d) no guilds

4. Why did Ashoka send his son and daughter to Sri Lanka, according to tradition? 1

(a) to hide **(b)** to conquer
(c) to spread Buddhism and dhamma **(d)** to trade

5. Which of the following explains why Tamil rulers supported poets? 1

(a) to avoid war **(b)** to gain fame and legitimacy
(c) to avoid trade **(d)** to avoid taxes

6. Which feature of the Gupta temple at Deogarh is notable? 1

(a) a church **(b)** carved panels of Vishnu's avatars
(c) a mosque **(d)** a stupa

7. Which factor most explains Magadha's military edge? 1

(a) no iron **(b)** bronze tools
(c) no army **(d)** iron weapons and elephants

8. Which of these is a plausible reason for Ashoka's choice of Brahmi script for most edicts? 1

(a) it was widely understood in most of his empire
(b) it was Greek
(c) it was unknown
(d) it was secret

9. Why did the political map after the Mauryas become fragmented? 1

(a) no strong central power and rise of regional rulers
(b) no rulers
(c) no states
(d) one dynasty ruled

10. A reason that Gupta kings used marriage alliances such as Prabhavati's was to 1

(a) end trade
(b) stop taxes
(c) increase wars
(d) secure diplomatic and political support

11. Why were mahajanapadas frequently at war? 1

(a) peace treaties
(b) no resources
(c) no kings
(d) competition for land, resources and power

12. How does the building of roads and rest houses benefit rulers? 1

(a) it hides troops
(b) it blocks trade
(c) it helps control territory and revenue
(d) it ends travel

13. **Assertion (A):** The Shaka Samvat is used as India's national calendar. 1
Reason (R): The Shaka Samvat begins in 78 CE.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** The Prayaga Prashasti praises Samudragupta. 1
Reason (R): It was composed by Harisena, his court poet.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** The first Indian coins were made of paper. 1
Reason (R): They were called punch-marked coins.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why did new dynasties emerge after the Mauryas? 2

17. What does land grant tell us about society? 2

18. Why is archaeology needed in addition to texts? 2

19. Why did Ashoka choose public places for edicts? 2

20. How do coins show trade links? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Analyse why the Kushana empire promoted cultural synthesis. 3

22. Analyse how foreign accounts and inscriptions complement each other. 3

23. Examine how rivers shaped the location of capitals. 3

24. Analyse why symbols of Ashoka were adopted by modern India. 3

OR

Evaluate the Hathigumpha as a source for Kalinga. 3

25. Evaluate the position of women in the Gupta period. 3

OR

Compare life in villages and cities in the period. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** Gautamiputra Satakarni was a Satavahana king of the Deccan. His mother, Gautami Balashri, had an inscription made at Nashik that praises his victories. Satavahana coins carried ship symbols, and traders sold pepper and cotton cloth to distant lands. 5

(i) In which region did the Satavahanas rule?

(ii) Where was the inscription of Gautami Balashri placed?

(iii) What do ship symbols on coins suggest?

(iv) Why is an inscription like this useful to a historian?

27. Evaluate the sources for the Satavahanas and Kushanas and what they reveal. 5

OR

Evaluate the achievements of the Gupta age in science, literature and arts. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

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